ZCAS University

SMS 1281: ACADEMIC WRITING

Final examination

Date: 27th May, 2025

Time: 09:00-12:00 Hours

TIME ALLOWED: THREE HOURS (plus 5 minutes to read through the paper)

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. Section A: this question is **compulsory** and must be attempted.
2. Sections B: Answer Three (3) questions from this section.
3. This examination paper carries a total of **100 marks**.
4. Candidates must **not turn this page** until the invigilator tells them to do so.

SECTION A: Question 1 is compulsory and must be attempted

Question one

You are the Assistant Public Relations Officer at the Zambia Centre for Accountancy Studies (ZCAS) University. The university is planning to host its first-ever Cultural Day on 25th June 2025 to celebrate the diversity of cultures within the university community. The event is expected to be colourful and unifying, showcasing cultural expressions from students and staff alike. The Cultural Day will feature a variety of activities including cultural dances, traditional games, a food fair, cultural exhibitions, and a march-past from the Post Office on Cairo Road to the ZCAS University campus. All staff and students are expected to participate in the march-past, and students from different backgrounds are encouraged to wear traditional attire and carry national flags representing their cultures. Notably, ambassadors from different countries will also be in attendance as invited guests, making this a high-profile event for the institution. The Public Relations Office has tasked you with drafting an internal memo to all students informing them about the Cultural Day, outlining the planned activities, participation guidelines, and the significance of the event.

Task:

A. Write a **memo** addressed to **all ZCAS University students**. Your memo should clearly announce the Cultural Day events, encourage student participation, and explain the importance of the event. use sentence and outline format. (30 Marks)

B. Identify and explain 5 types of memos used in organisations. **(10 Marks)**

(Total 40 Marks)

SECTION B: Attempt any THREE questions in this section

Question Two

You are a senior officer in the Disaster Management and Mitigation Unit (DMMU) under the Cabinet Office. Recently, the Director DMMU assigned you to lead a fact-finding mission following a fatal mining accident in the Copperbelt region, which resulted in the loss of approximately 20 miners.

Preliminary investigations (findings) from the field observations and interviews revealed serious safety lapses, including the lack of protective gear and ongoing mining activities without proper legal documentation. During the site visit, you and your technical team discovered several miners trapped underground, prompting immediate DMMU intervention. The unit responded by deploying emergency technical support, including rescue equipment, food supplies, tents, and coordination with local authorities.

Additionally, you conducted interviews with eyewitnesses and community members who raised grave concerns about the safety and regulation of small-scale mining operations. A recurring theme in their testimonies was the urgent need for government support to improve working conditions and safety in the mining sector, especially for small-scale miners.

Task

Prepare a comprehensive business report addressed to the Director of the Disaster Management and Mitigation Unit (DMMU) **(20 Marks)**

Question Three

A. Public speaking plays a vital role in various professional, academic, and social settings. Effective speakers are often required to inform, persuade, celebrate special occasions, or respond spontaneously to unexpected situations.

Task:

Identify and discuss the various types of public speaking by providing a clear definition

of each type, relevant example, purpose, and characteristics that define each type of public speaking (10 marks)

B. Many people experience glossophobia, which can negatively impact their ability to communicate effectively.

Task:

Explain what glossophobia is and discuss at least **four common causes** of this fear. In your response, illustrate how each cause can affect a speaker's performance in public speaking situations. (10 Marks)

(Total 20 Marks)

Question Four

Plagiarism is widely recognized as a serious breach of academic integrity, carrying significant ethical, legal, and professional consequences. Despite numerous institutional efforts to combat it, many students still struggle to fully understand its forms, implications, and how to avoid it in practice.

Task

A. Critically analyse the concept of plagiarism in academic writing. In your answer, discuss not only its definition but also evaluate five reasons why plagiarism is considered unethical and how it affects the credibility of scholarly work. (10 Marks)

B. With relevant examples, examine three prevalent forms of plagiarism found in higher education. In your response, explore the subtle distinctions between these forms and why students may unintentionally commit them. (10 marks)

(Total 20 marks)

Question Five

Write brief notes on the following

A. Analytical writing (4 marks)
B. Persuasive writing (4 Marks)
C. Descriptive writing (4 Marks)
D. Argumentative writing (4 Marks)
E. Expository writing (4 Marks)

(Total 20 marks)

End of Examination